

Introduction

Hacking and ethical hacking are often subject to much misinterpretation. We've tried to deconstruct some of those myths and introduce readers to some of the basic concepts of ethical hacking.

The book itself can be divided into three parts, the Introduction, Information Security, and Hacking the web / network.

In the Introduction to this book, we have tried to give readers a clearer idea of what exactly constitutes hacking. We explore the ethical lines of hacking, and the dissonance between ethical as a legal or moral binding. We question why the term even needs the prefix "ethical". We also take a look at the terms Black Hat hacker and White Hat hacker and how to distinguish between them.

In our second section on Information Security we deal with some of the most basic devices for security and access control: Passwords. In the chapter "Access Denied" we look at exactly what does it take for a password to be secure? We look at what makes a strong password strong and some of the technical limits to cracking password. We also look at brute force and dictionary attacks as means of password cracking.

In the second chapter on "Social Engineering" we explore the social engineering, as a concept of using social means for finding passwords instead of purely electronic means. Here we will look at some of the popular modes of social engineering.

In the chapter "The ethical bit" we explore the ethical uses of knowing how to crack passwords. We see how knowing the processes by which passwords are hacked can help us pick better uncrackable passwords. We look at how one can have a password which is easy to remember and strong at the same time.

In "Hashes" we look at some of the uses of hashes in information security and how they can be cracked to reveal a password. The "What the #!" chapter then deals with what exactly a hash is, how it relates to passwords and how can it be hacked. We explore all these questions and explore the basic function and operation of hashes.

In "Of Rainbows and Salt" we look at hash chains, and rainbow tables,